



The Leica S2 has a DSLR sensor some 50 per-cent larger than other full-frame DSLRs

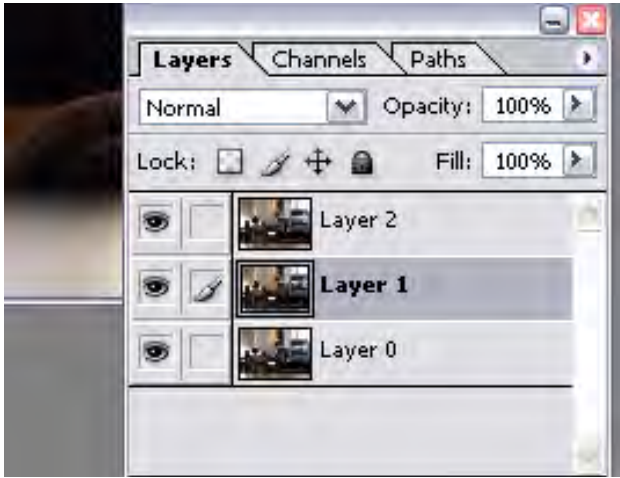


Figure 3: The different images copied into a single file as layers

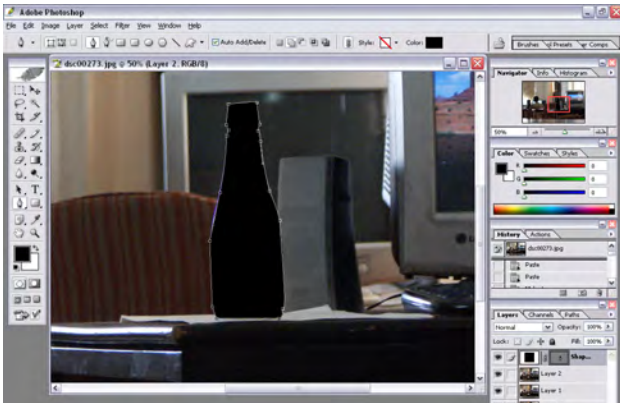


Figure 4: Creating a path to isolate the object

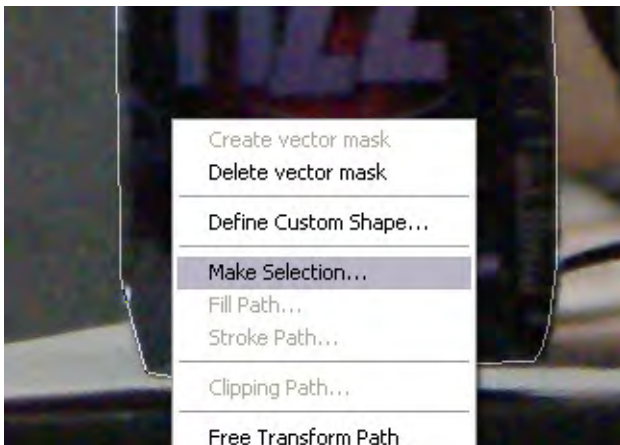


Figure 5: Converting the path to a selection

tion by pressing the [Del] key or through the Edit menu so you are left with just the object floating in air.

Step 7: Save the image by clicking on File > Save As. Choose a format such as JPG that doesn't show layers or masks.

Improvements can always be made to this technique. Adding a shadow under the object adds more realism to the photo. You can do this by using a large sized, but soft brush tool and adding some darkness on the floor where the shadow would fall. You

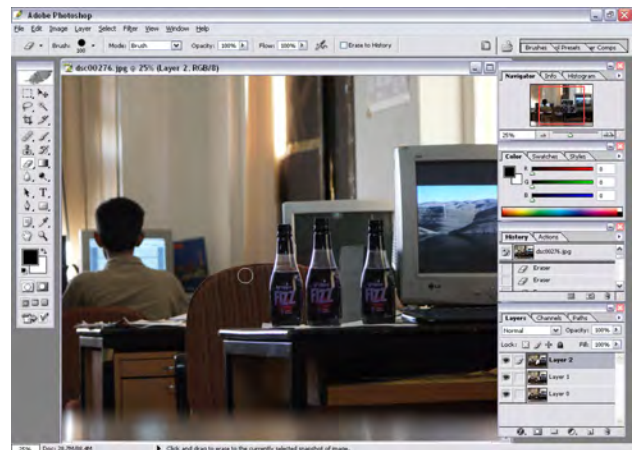
can also take an additional photograph and ask someone to hold a sheet or paper or a big bag over the where the object would float so you can capture a shadow and similarly composite it into your image.

Replicating objects

There are plenty of tricks one can do with the method in the previous trick. In this particular trick, we'll use the same idea but have the same object in different places at the same time.

Take multiple shots with the camera on a tripod with the object in different places. While starting off, simply use two or three instances of yourself preferably not overlapping anywhere in the photo. Keep the same distance and do not move anything else in the scene. Use Photoshop to open all these photographs into separate layers and use the eraser tool as well as the Pen tool to clear out each of the instances.

One of the biggest hurdles has to do with the variations in colours and the characteristics of the photo that take place especially with automated point and shoot cameras. Small changes are made by the camera which result in the image turning out a little bit brighter or darker. If the outlines for the characters aren't cut



Three instances of a bottle

out clearly, then there's a layer around the subject with a slightly different shade left behind. Use a soft healing tool from the toolbar to clear these patches up. Do not merge the layers together as you can control each of the layers individually. This way, you can continue to change properties of the layers independently, such as the lighting and colour balances. Tweak these to make the final image as realistic as possible.

Gigapixel imaging

Now this isn't really a trick but it's something cool that you might have read of or seen online. People boast of really high resolution images going into gigapixel resolutions. But you don't need a really expensive camera that costs several lakh to do that. The trick is to taking a gigapixel image is to use any camera and take as many shots as possible. Obviously you can't just go around shooting random photographs — it has been done in an orderly manner. It is preferable to use a tripod for this experiment as well.

We'll be using a program called Microsoft HD View which let's you view and create your own gigapixel images with your standard point and shoot camera. You can download and install the plugin for Windows browsers from <http://tinyurl.com/dkp27g>.

Step 1: Mount the camera, set the camera to capture at its maximum resolution, and turn off the flash. Set the aperture size, shutter speed and ISO rating such that your exposure ratings are normal and you won't get dark results. Click a few test shots to be sure.